

CANDIDATE THESIS

The portfolio is a protocol, not a pile of projects.

Real mandate

Install a trusted portfolio operating system for approximately four AI workstreams so senior leaders can make timely decisions about value, risk, spend, dependencies, quality, and adoption while technical and scientific teams retain room for legitimate discovery.

CENTRAL OPERATING CONTRADICTIONS

Tension	What it protects	What it can cost	Program mechanism
Agile cadence vs. evidence cadence	Momentum and learning	False certainty or delayed decisions	Separate sprint progress from decision readiness
Portfolio consistency vs. scientific difference	Comparability and control	Methodological flattening	Common evidence fields, differentiated delivery paths
Governance vs. velocity	Quality, privacy, compliance, trust	Late-stage rework when controls arrive late	Embed authority and evidence at the point of work
Budget discipline vs. discovery uncertainty	Stewardship and prioritization	Forecast theater	Ranges, triggers, assumptions, and explicit sponsor decisions
Executive visibility vs. report theater	Alignment and accountability	Activity without decisions	Exception-led steering narrative

AI PORTFOLIO PROTOCOL

Decision field	Question the portfolio must answer
1. Value evidence	What outcome is expected, who owns the baseline, and what evidence supports the commitment?
2. Data/model readiness	What data quality, access, evaluation, monitoring, and infrastructure conditions must be true?
3. Human/quality authority	Who may rely on the output, override it, approve it, investigate exceptions, and accept residual risk?
4. Spend and forecast	What has been spent, what is forecast, what uncertainty remains, and what decision changes the commitment?
5. Dependencies	Which teams, vendors, systems, data sources, controls, or environments are on the critical path?
6. Adoption ownership	Who changes the workflow, enables users, monitors sustained use, and owns the capability after delivery?

GOVERNANCE CADENCE

Workstream cadence Backlog, sprint/flow, demos, technical risk, dependency actions, user feedback.	Portfolio cadence Roadmap, budget, capacity, interdependencies, risk, change burden, value evidence.	Executive cadence Decision required, tradeoff, forecast movement, confidence, next commitment.
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CANDIDATE ADVANTAGE

A cross-domain operator who can make specialist work easier to govern.

Science-grounded translation

Materials science, physical chemistry, biology-related studies, R&D program experience, technical publishing, and industry talks support credible conversations with technical specialists.

AI attached to real work

Current AI-first operations plus AI-readiness, agentic workflow, retrieval, human review, evaluation, and governance patterns keep the portfolio connected to workflows and outcomes.

High-reliability operating judgment

Quality systems, technical-program leadership, regulated operations, safety discipline, root cause, and explicit authority boundaries strengthen risk decisions.

Executive-to-team continuity

Director-level cadence, Amazon scaled execution, board leadership, vendor and partner coordination, and hands-on mechanism building connect governance to delivery.

PROOF MAP

Vape-Jet	Current AI-first transformation across production, quality, support, engineering issue flow, enterprise systems, telemetry, and a fielded robotics fleet.
DudeWorth	AI opportunity, readiness, governance, adoption, human-authority, evaluation, and agentic workflow mechanisms.
Amazon	Scaled launch cadence, customer-backward operating mechanisms, Lean/Gemba, standard work, escalation, and approximately five million annual second-day orders.
Compunetics	R&D, engineering, manufacturing, quality, high-reliability programs, technical liaison work, industry publishing, and complex customer delivery.

FIRST 90 DAYS

Days 1-30 · Read

• Map authority and stakeholders

• Reconcile portfolio, roadmap, budget, risks, dependencies, and value hypotheses

• Observe how decisions actually move

Days 31-60 · Install

• Launch the six-field protocol

• Integrate budget, roadmap, risk, and change evidence

• Coach teams and sponsors in the cadence

Days 61-90 · Prove

• Use real decisions to test the mechanisms

• Remove reports that do not improve judgment

• Transfer ownership and a learning loop

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

1. What decisions must the AI Transformation Office make consistently across workstreams?	2. Where does the current governance model create confidence, and where does it create reporting burden without improving a decision?
3. Which workstream dependency is most consequential today?	4. How are R&D priorities converted into delivery priorities across sponsors, Digital/IT, quality, compliance, and finance?
5. What evidence would make sponsors comfortable advancing, narrowing, or stopping a workstream?	6. What would make this Program Manager indispensable by day 90?

Interview close

I would work through one anonymized workstream decision together, show the six fields, clarify authority and budget assumptions, and demonstrate how the protocol turns a status conversation into a precise governance decision.

Interview thesis brief · Independent candidate material

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